

Landforms and Lifes

Landforms

- A landform is a physical feature on the Earth's surface.
 - Main types of landforms:
 1. Mountains
 2. Plateaus
 3. Plains
 - Landforms affect:
 - Climate
 - Flora and fauna
 - Human life and culture
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Mountains

Features

- Very high landforms with:
 - Broad base
 - Steep slopes
 - Narrow summit
- Some mountains remain snow-capped throughout the year.
- Lower highlands with rounded tops are called hills.

Important Mountain Ranges

- Himalayas – Asia
- Alps – Europe
- Andes – South America

Important Peaks

- Mount Everest – highest peak in the world
- Kanchenjunga – Himalayan peak
- Mount Kilimanjaro – Africa

- **Anamudi – highest peak in South India**
- **Mount Blanc -Highest mountain in A**

Young and Old Mountains

- **Young mountains:**
 - **Tall and sharp peaks**
 - **Example: Himalayas**
 - **Old mountains:**
 - **Rounded due to erosion**
 - **Example: Aravalli Range**
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Mountain Environment

Vegetation

- **Covered with montane forests**
- **Common trees:**
 - **Pine**
 - **Fir**
 - **Spruce**
 - **Deodar**
- **Higher regions have:**
 - **Grasses**
 - **Mosses**
 - **Lichens**

Animals

Examples:

- **Snow leopard**
- **Yak**
- **ibex**
- **Golden eagle**
- **Black bear**
- **Himalayan tahr**

Life in Mountains

Occupations

- **Terrace farming**
- **Herding**
- **Tourism**

Tourist Activities

- **Skiing**
- **Hiking**
- **Mountaineering**
- **Paragliding**
- **Pilgrimages**

Challenges

- **Landslides**
- **Avalanches**
- **Heavy snowfall**
- **Flash floods**
- **Cloudbursts**
- **Cold weather**
- **Pressure from uncontrolled tourism**

Important Personalities

- **Bachendri Pal:**
 - **First Indian woman to climb Mount Everest (1984)**
 - **Arunima Sinha:**
 - **First female amputee to climb Mount Everest**
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Plateaus

Features

- **Elevated flat-topped landforms**
- **Often have steep sides**
- **Rich in minerals**

Important Plateaus

- **Tibetan Plateau – “Roof of the World”**
- **Deccan Plateau – one of the oldest plateaus**

Economic Importance

- **Mining of:**
 - **Iron**
 - **Coal**
 - **Gold**
 - **Diamond**
 - **Manganese**

Soil

- **Usually rocky and less fertile**
- **Lava plateaus have fertile black soil**

Famous Waterfalls

- **Victoria Falls**
 - **Jog Falls**
 - **Hundru Falls**
 - **Nohkalikai Falls**
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Plains

Features

- **Flat or gently sloping landforms**
- **Usually below 300 m above sea level**

Formation

- **Rivers bring and deposit sediments:**
 - **Sand**
 - **Silt**
 - **Rock particles**
- **Makes plains very fertile**

Importance

- **Best region for agriculture**
- **Densely populated**
- **Easy transportation and navigation**

Crops Grown

- **Rice**
- **Wheat**
- **Maize**
- **Barley**
- **Millet**
- **Cotton**
- **Jute**

Problems in Plains

- **Pollution**
 - **Overpopulation**
 - **Groundwater depletion due to irrigation**
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Rivers and Culture

- **Rivers are culturally important worldwide.**
 - **Sacred places:**
 - **River sources**
 - **Confluences**
 - **Many festivals and rituals are connected with rivers.**
 - **Rivers support:**
 - **Fishing**
 - **Transport**
 - **Agriculture**
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Deserts

Features

- **Dry regions with very little rainfall**
- **Unique plants and animals**

Types

- **Hot deserts:**
 - **Sahara Desert**
 - **Thar Desert**
- **Cold deserts:**
 - **Gobi Desert**

Human Life

- **People adapt through:**
 - **Migration**
 - **Special traditions**
 - **Folk songs and legends**
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Important Terms

Term	Meaning
Altitude	Height above sea level
Precipitation	Rain, snow or hail reaching Earth
Terrace Farming	Farming on mountain steps
Avalanche	Sudden fall of snow or ice
Landslide	Sudden collapse of rock or soil
Flash Flood	Sudden local flood
Confluence	Meeting point of rivers
Montane Forest	Forests in mountains
Resilience	Ability to overcome difficulties
